

Post Workout Nutrition

Foods That Support Recovery

After exercise, the body benefits from nutrients that support muscle repair, replenishment of energy stores, and rehydration. A combination of protein and carbohydrate within a couple of hours after exercise supports these processes.

Why Post-Workout Nutrition Matters

Exercise depletes glycogen (stored carbohydrate) and causes small amounts of muscle breakdown. Eating after a workout helps replenish glycogen, supports muscle repair, and can improve recovery before the next session. Protein provides amino acids for repair, while carbohydrates restore energy stores.

Good Post-Workout Food Combinations

A useful general guideline is to combine protein and carbohydrate in roughly a 1:3 ratio. Timing is flexible - eating within a few hours of exercise is sufficient for most people. Examples of balanced post-workout meals include:

Suggested Items:

- Curd with banana and a handful of nuts
- Whole wheat bread with peanut butter and a glass of milk
- A bowl of dal with rice and a side of curd
- Scrambled eggs with whole grain toast and fruit
- Sprouts salad with lemon and a boiled egg
- A smoothie with milk, banana, and peanut butter

Reference Table

Combination	Protein (g)	Carbs (g)
Curd + banana + nuts	15	40
Bread + peanut butter + milk	20	45
Dal + rice + curd	18	55
Eggs + toast + fruit	18	40
Smoothie (milk, banana, peanut butter)	20	50

Conclusion

Rehydration is just as important as food. Drinking water, and for long or sweaty sessions, an electrolyte drink, supports fluid balance.